



KEYCAST BRIDGE

User Guide

Version 0.2.0-alpha.7

Keycast Bridge displays keyboard shortcuts, held modifiers and, optionally, mouse clicks in a transparent OBS Browser Source. The application controls capture and appearance; OBS overlays the result on top of your screen or application capture.

[Windows x64](#)

[Debian 13](#)

[OBS Browser Source](#)

[Open source](#)

github.com/sjeje42/keycast-bridge

1. Install and launch

Windows x64

Download the Windows ZIP from the project Releases. Extract the entire archive into a writable folder, then run keycast-bridge.exe. Keep the DLLs and subfolders next to the executable. There is no installer, driver or persistent service. Run the application as a normal user.

Note This alpha build is unsigned. Secure desktops, UAC windows and applications running as administrator are outside the supported capture target.

Debian 13 amd64

Download the Debian package from Releases, open a terminal in that folder and run:

```
sudo apt install ./keycast-bridge_0.2.0.alpha.7-1_amd64.deb
```

Launch Keycast Bridge from the application menu. Do not run the interface with sudo. Starting capture requests administrator authorization through Polkit; the capture helper then handles the devices. You do not need to add yourself to the input group.

OBS must provide a Browser Source. If your Linux build does not include it, the official OBS Flatpak is the documented option for this project. The Keycast Bridge Debian package does not install OBS.

Other Linux distributions

Build instructions for Ubuntu 24.04+, Linux Mint 22.x, Fedora, Manjaro and Arch are in the repository README. The downloadable Debian package targets Debian 13. Prerequisites include GTK 4.8+, Rust, Node.js 22 and development files for libudev and libxkbcommon.

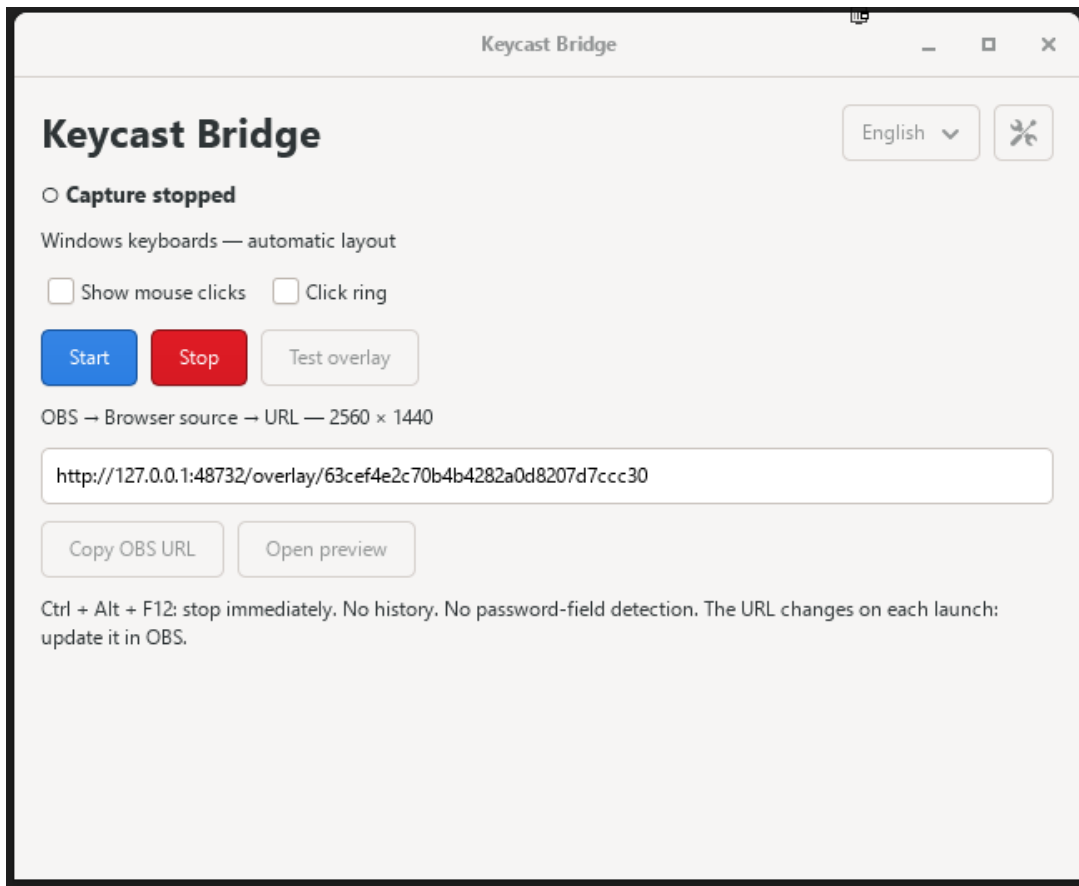
Updates and removal

On Windows, stop capture, close the old application and extract the new ZIP into a new folder. On Debian, install the new .deb with APT. Appearance and canvas preferences are stored separately and survive updates. To remove the Debian package, use `sudo apt remove keycast-bridge`. Only one instance can use the local server port at a time.

2. First setup in OBS

1. Open Keycast Bridge and select the interface language if needed.
2. Click the gear icon, open Canvas and size, then choose the source format, for example 1920 × 1080.
3. Return to the main window and click Copy OBS URL.
4. In OBS: Sources → + → Browser. Create a source and paste the URL.
5. Enter exactly the same width and height in the Browser Source properties.
6. Place this source above your display or application capture and align their rectangles. Keep the overlay background transparent.
7. Click Test overlay. A demo shortcut appears briefly. This button stops an active capture.
8. Choose your capture options, click Start and authorize capture on Linux.

Important The URL changes every time Keycast Bridge restarts. Copy the new URL into OBS after each launch. Do not share this private local address.



Main window - English interface

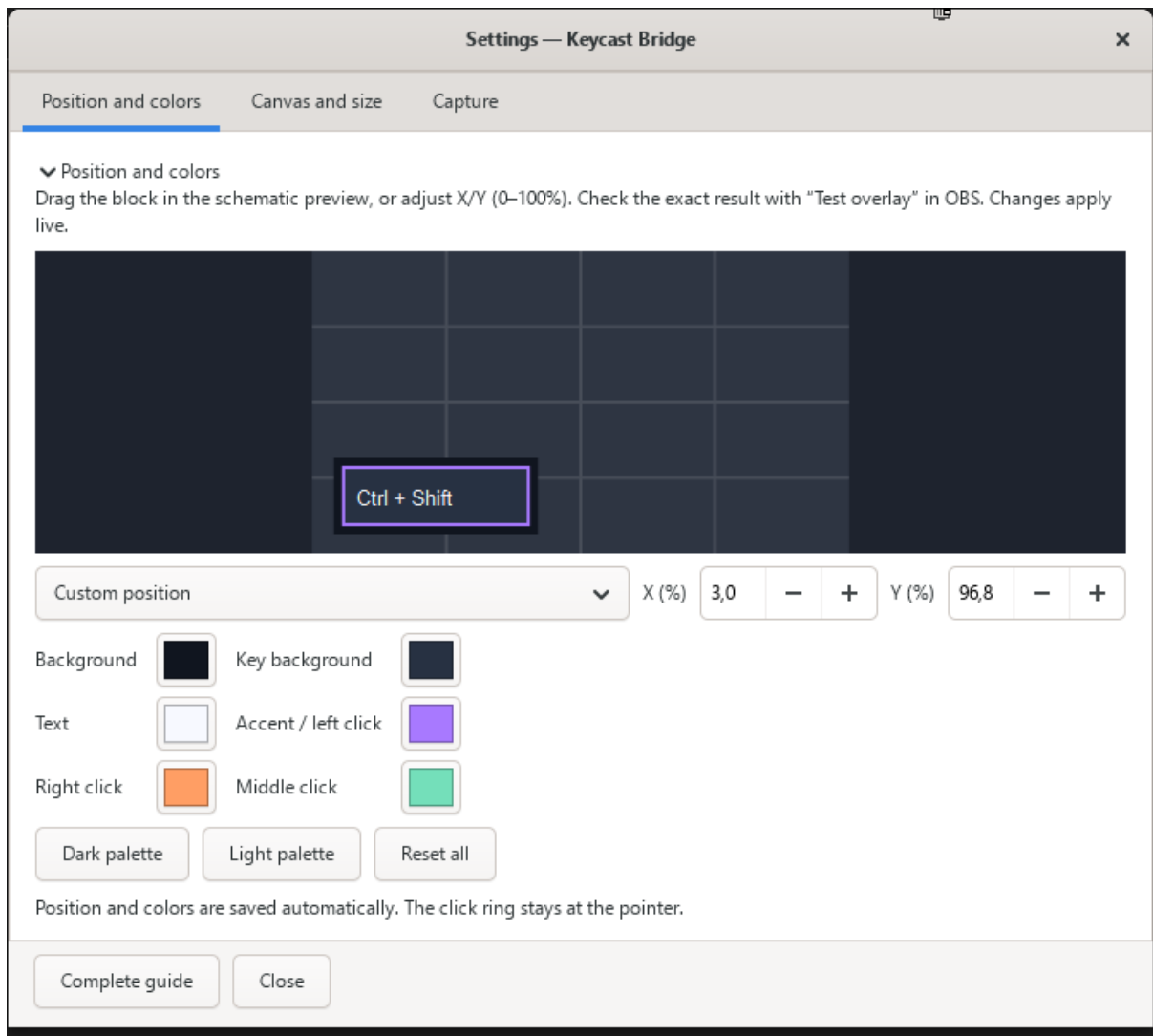
3. Main window

The compact main window shows capture status, mouse options, Start/Stop/Test controls, the OBS URL, selected canvas format and preview controls. Its size adapts to detected displays; a scrollbar remains available on very small screens or with strong UI scaling.

Control	Purpose
Start	Start capture with the selected options.
Stop	Stop capture and clear the overlay.
Ctrl + Alt + F12	Emergency stop; the shortcut is also received by the active application.
Test overlay	Stop capture and display a sample so you can verify OBS.
Copy OBS URL	Copy the local session address.
Open preview	Open the overlay in a browser; it may look empty when nothing is displayed.
Gear icon	Open Settings without interrupting capture.

Closing Settings leaves both the application and capture running. Closing the main window stops capture. Appearance and canvas format can be changed while recording. To change keyboards, layout, text visibility or mouse capture, stop and restart capture.

4. Settings - Position and colors



Settings - Position and colors

Place the overlay

Drag the sample block inside the schematic preview. You can also choose one of nine preset positions or enter X/Y percentages manually.

- X = 0 is the left edge; X = 100 is the right edge.
- Y = 0 is the top edge; Y = 100 is the bottom edge.
- 50/50 centers the block. The default position is 50/100, bottom center.
- Percentages represent the available movement area and account for the block size.

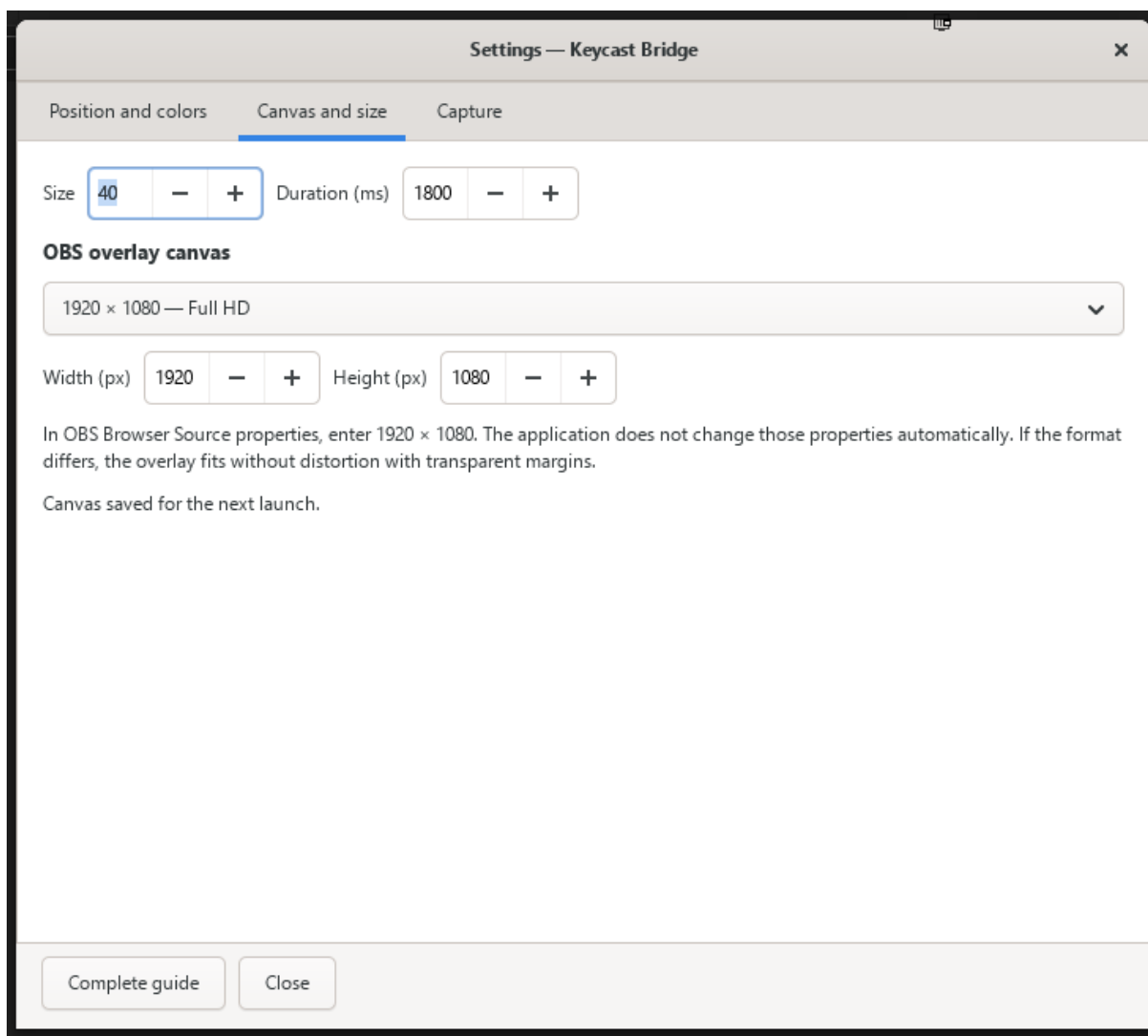
The last-shortcut line and the modifier/mouse line move together. The preview respects the selected canvas proportions, but key shapes are schematic: check the actual size in OBS.

Customize colors

Color	Affected elements
Background	Translucent background of each line.
Key background	Surface of each key.
Text	Letters, separators and mouse outline.
Accent / left click	Held-key outline, left button and Windows click ring.
Right click	Right-button highlight.
Middle click	Middle-button highlight.

Dark palette and Light palette restore coordinated color sets while preserving position and dimensions. Reset all, in this tab, resets only position and colors.

5. Settings - Canvas and size



Settings - Canvas and size

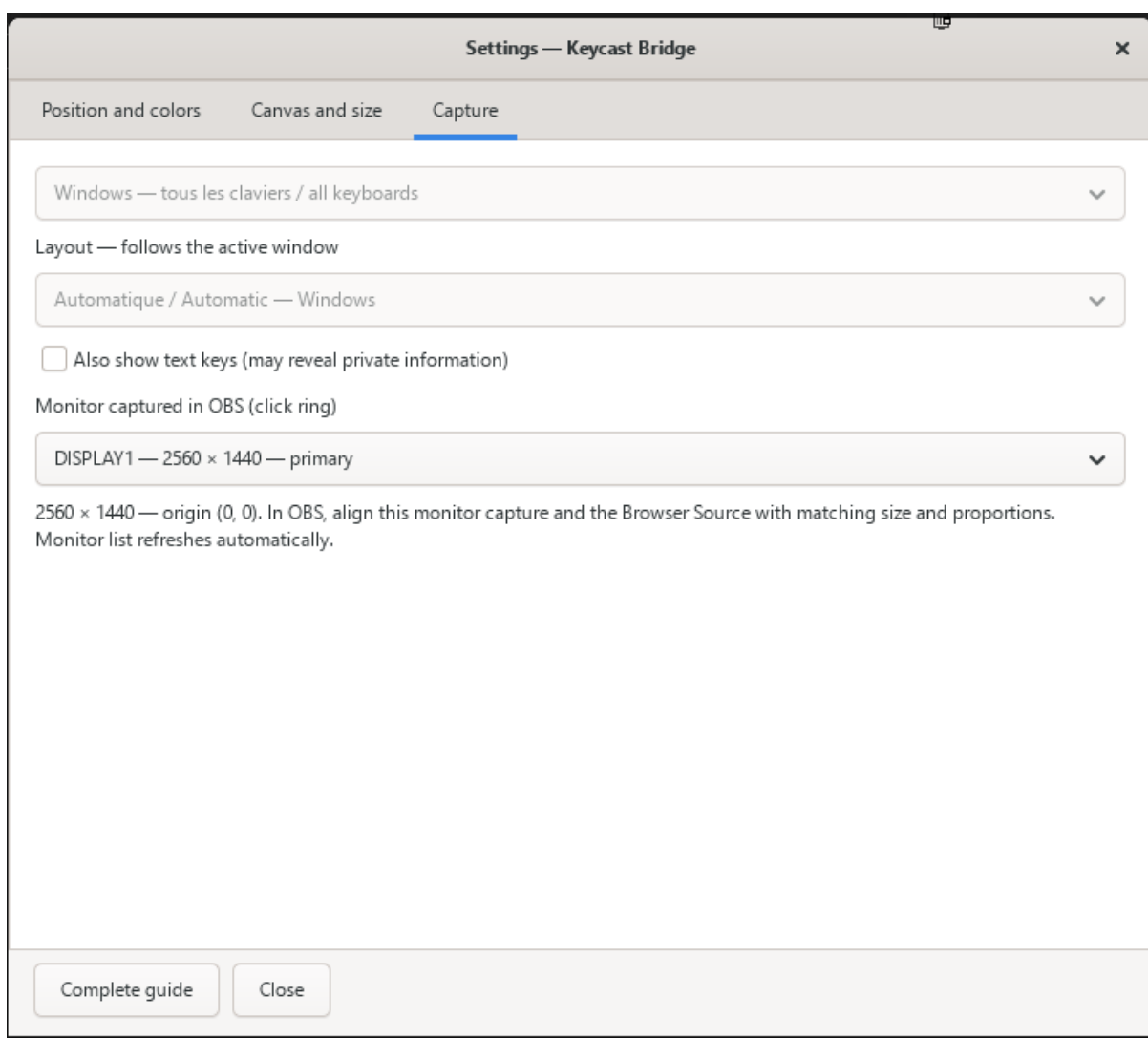
Size controls key text from 20 to 96 pixels in the logical canvas. Duration controls how long the last shortcut stays visible, from 300 to 5000 ms. Held modifiers remain visible until released.

Presets: 1280 × 720, 1920 × 1080, 2560 × 1440, 3840 × 2160, 1080 × 1920 and 1080 × 1080. Custom width and height can each range from 160 to 7680 pixels.

Key point These values define the logical overlay canvas but do not remotely change OBS Browser Source properties. Enter the same dimensions in OBS for the intended result.

If aspect ratios differ, the overlay is uniformly scaled to fit and transparent margins are added without distortion. For a vertical 1080 × 1920 tutorial, use that format in both Keycast Bridge and the OBS Browser Source.

6. Settings - Capture



Settings - Capture

Keyboards and layout

On Linux, the default captures all recognized keyboards, including devices connected later. You can select specific keyboards and choose a matching layout: French AZERTY, US or UK QWERTY, or German QWERTZ. On Windows, all keyboards in the session are captured and the layout follows the active window.

Shortcuts, text and modifiers

Ordinary text characters are filtered by default. Shift, Ctrl, Alt, Win/Super and AltGr remain visible while held, even without another key. Left/right variants are grouped.

Also show text keys extends capture to ordinary text. This can reveal private information and passwords. The application does not detect password fields, so stop capture before typing anything sensitive.

Mouse and multiple monitors

Enable Show mouse clicks before starting. Left, right and middle buttons have separate colors. Very short clicks stay visible for at least 150 ms; mouse-wheel scrolling is not displayed.

On Windows, Click ring also works with a single monitor. With multiple monitors, choose the display captured in OBS under Settings → Capture. The ring appears in the OBS overlay, not directly on the Windows desktop. Accurate alignment requires matching aspect ratios and aligned, uncropped rectangles. On Linux/Wayland, keyboard and mouse buttons work across multiple monitors, but a pointer-position click ring is not available.

7. Persistence and privacy

Position, colors and canvas format are saved automatically. Other settings - size, duration, capture options, selected monitor and language - are session-only in this alpha.

System	Preferences file
Windows	%APPDATA%\keycast-bridge\appearance.json
Linux	\$XDG_CONFIG_HOME/keycast-bridge/appearance.json or ~/.config/keycast-bridge/appearance.json

This file stores appearance and canvas settings only: no keystrokes, mouse history or OBS URL. The server listens only on local IPv4 at port 48732. There is no telemetry, no keystroke history and no automatic capture at startup.

Privacy Capture does not stop automatically when the session is locked. Stop it before locking your computer or before entering sensitive information.

8. Troubleshooting

Problem	Checks
Browser Source missing in OBS on Linux	Use an OBS build that includes it; the official Flatpak is the documented option.
Overlay is empty	Use Test overlay; check source order/visibility and session URL. Ordinary text is filtered by default.
OBS shows an old page	Copy the URL again after restarting Keycast Bridge, then

	refresh the Browser Source.
Position or size differs	Match canvas/OBS dimensions and check cropping, transforms and key size.
Mouse buttons are missing	Stop, enable Show mouse clicks, then restart capture.
Click ring is offset or missing	Windows: enable it, select the correct monitor and align sources without cropping.
Linux authorization fails	Check the installed package/helper and Polkit request; do not run the UI as root.
Windows executable does not start	Extract the entire ZIP and keep DLLs and folders together.
Application exits immediately	Close another instance using port 48732.

Guide or preview does not open

On Windows, the button uses the system default browser. If Windows refuses to open it, a dialog offers Copy link. The guide is also available offline in [guide/en.html](#) next to the executable.

For a useful bug report, include the application version, operating system, desktop and scaling, selected canvas, OBS Browser Source dimensions and reproduction steps. Hide the session URL and any private information in screenshots.